LUIS CALDERON

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Personal

Citizenship: U.S. (German in progress)
Languages: English, Spanish, German (B1)
Ethnicity: Latino

Placement

Director: Prof. Stephan Lauermann
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Coordinator: Dr. Silke Kinzig
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RESEARCH INTERESTS & METHODS

Macroeconomics, household heterogeneity, monetary and fiscal policy, Bayesian econometrics, functional data analysis

POSITION

University of Bonn *From August 2026*
Postdoctoral Researcher, Institute for Macroeconomics and Econometrics

EDUCATION

University of Bonn, Germany *Winter 2020 – Summer 2026*
Ph.D. in Economics, *summa cum laude*
M.Sc. in Economics with a specialization in research

University of Bonn, Germany *Winter 2018 – Summer 2020*
M.Sc. in Economics

Florida International University, Miami, FL *Fall 2013 – Fall 2017*
B.B.A. in Finance
B.A. in Economics

REFERENCES

Christian Bayer
University of Bonn
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Benjamin Born
University of Bonn
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Farzad Saidi
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Institute for Finance
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Moritz Kuhn
University of Mannheim
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JOB MARKET PAPER

Distributional Dynamics
With Christian Bayer and Moritz Kuhn. CEPR Discussion Paper 19829. Link.

We develop a new framework for estimating high-frequency distributional dynamics across multiple economic variables. Our approach delivers synthetic microdata by combining existing microdata sources that can differ in frequency, variable coverage, and measurement concepts. Central to the framework is treating distributions as functional time series and representing their dynamics through a factor structure. We embed these factors in a state-space model and use Bayesian estimation to recover the underlying distributions from sparse and noisy observations. We apply the framework to the joint distribution of consumption, income, and wealth, which is central to modern heterogeneous-agent macroeconomics. Using a wide range of U.S. microdata and macroeconomic time series, we construct the first quarterly estimates of this joint distribution from 1962 to 2024. We demonstrate that our approach reliably recovers its evolution, even when direct observations are sparse or unavailable. These new data provide previously unavailable empirical counterparts to the distributional dynamics at the heart of modern heterogeneous-agent macroeconomics.

WORKING PAPERS

Policy Rules and Policy Tools: The Price of Distributional Stabilization

Not All Oil Supply Shocks are Alike: The Macroeconomic and Distributional Impact of Oil Supply Shocks
May 2026. Link.

Spatial Standard Errors for Several Commonly Used M-estimators
With Leander Heldring. *R&R at the International Journal of Computational Economics and Econometrics.* Link.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Distributional Dynamics: Germany
With Christian Bayer and Moritz Kuhn

Sectoral Job Levels and Productivity
With Christian Bayer, Moritz Kuhn and See-Yu Chan. Slides.

Household Debt Dilution

The Fiscal Roots of Wealth Inequality: Corporate Concentration and the Eroding Tax Base

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Bonn Graduate School of Economics

Class: Coding in Julia and Stata (PhD)	*Winter 2021–2025*
Class: Topics in Inequality (BSc)	*Summer 2024*
Class: Macroeconomics I (BSc)	*Summer 2025, 2026*
Winter School: BASEforHANK (for PhDs and central bankers)	*December 2025*

RESEARCH ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

Department of Macroeconomics, University of Mannheim *January 2024 – September 2024*
PIs: Christian Bayer and Moritz Kuhn
Project: Datawork on Job Levels project

Institute of Macroeconomics and Econometrics, University of Bonn *June 2020 – 2022, 2025*
PIs: Christian Bayer, Benjamin Born, Ralph Luetticke, and Moritz Kuhn
Project 1: Shocks, Frictions, and Inequality in US Business Cycles
Project 2: BASEforHANK
Master Thesis: The Effects of Income Uncertainty on Liquidity, Default, and Prosperity

Institute on Behavior & Inequality (briq) *May 2019 – June 2020*
PI: Prof. Leander Heldring
Project 1: The Cost of State-building: Evidence from Germany
Project 2: Spatial standard errors for several commonly used M-estimators

MEMBERSHIPS AND ROLES

2024 – present: Member of Collaborative Research Center Transregio 224 "Economic Perspectives on Societal Challenges"
2022 – 2023: Member of RTG 2281 "The Macroeconomics of Inequality"
2021 – 2024: BGSE Student Body Representative
2024 – 2025: Kreisliga Basketball (PG), Volunteer for U18 games
2022 – 2026: Bonner Liga Basketball (PG and Treasurer)
2021 – 2026: NRW Liga Chess Player

ABSTRACTS

Working Papers

Policy Rules and Policy Tools: The Price of Distributional Stabilization

This paper asks an empirical question: following an oil supply shock, what aggregate and distributional outcomes can monetary and fiscal policy attain under existing and alternative mandates, different policy instruments, and alternative divisions of responsibility between monetary and fiscal authorities? Several results emerge. Indeed, the oil supply shock presents trade-offs for policy makers: inflation, real activity enters stagnation, and the distribution compresses. Conventional monetary policy in response cannot simultaneously stabilize inflation and consumption inequality, but of the two, has greater capacity to stabilize inequality. Layering unconventional monetary policy or one broad fiscal instrument on top relaxes this tension only slightly. Interestingly, both extensions generate similar stabilization of the targeted outcomes, but differ in their *untargeted* incidence. Irrespective of the set of instruments above, moving from the dual to a triple mandate that stabilizes consumption inequality comes at roughly a 3 to 1 cost, shared between inflation and unemployment, with fiscal policy the most efficient. On the division of responsibility: A dual mandate central bank and an inequality focused fiscal authority move outcomes closer to the cooperative benchmark; a central bank committed only to price stabilization achieves balanced stabilization across all outcomes; changing the Stackelberg leader has little effect.

Not All Oil Supply Shocks are Alike: The Macroeconomic and Distributional Impact of Oil Supply Shocks. Link.

Oil supply shocks shape U.S. inequality, and *the type of* oil supply shock matters for who bears the cost. In a Bayesian VAR that embeds the joint distribution of U.S. household income, consumption, and wealth alongside a standard oil-market block, sudden production shortfalls (Baumeister and Hamilton, 2019) raise inequality, whereas oil supply news (Känzig, 2021) mostly reduces it. These differences are not visible in the aggregate dynamics, which appear similar across shocks. A causal mediation analysis (Dufour and Wang, 2024) of these aggregate dynamics shows these shocks operate through distinct channels and it is this mechanism wedge, rather than the aggregate footprint, that determines who bears the cost. The analysis shares the view of Kilian and Lewis (2011) that policy responses should depend on the underlying causes of oil price shocks.

Spatial Standard Errors for Several Commonly Used M-estimators (with Leander Heldring). Link.

We provide a unified implementation of existing asymptotic theory that computes Conley-style spatial HAC standard errors for a wide range of commonly used (non-linear) estimators. We cover OLS, logit, probit, Poisson, and negative binomial regressions, as well as the fixed-effects estimators *areg* and *reghdfe*—extending commonly used publicly available routines (currently limited to linear models) to nonlinear M-estimators and fixed-effects workflows. We provide Stata and Python software implementing the procedure.

Works in Progress

Sectoral Job Levels and Productivity (with Christian Bayer, Moritz Kuhn and See-Yu Chan). Slides.

Bayer and Kuhn (2023) show that a worker's *job level* explains nearly half of the differences in pay between individual workers in Germany. Job levels (*Leistungsgruppen*) are an official five-step ladder on which the German statistical office classifies jobs by their complexity, the autonomy they allow, and the responsibility they carry. We build the long-run, economy-wide counterpart: a newly digitized quarterly panel of West German wages and employment by job level, 1958–2021, merged with sector productivity accounts (EU-KLEMS). We report three findings. **First**, part of the productivity growth that standard growth accounting attributes to technology is in fact workers moving into higher job levels: about 10% of measured total factor productivity (TFP) growth in our sectors over 1975–2006, and 30% in Finance, 19% in Mining and 10% in Manufacturing. About half of it comes from the growth of the highest level we observe and most of the rest from the shrinking of the two lowest levels. **Second**, across sectors, the average job level explains 57% of the differences in average pay within a year, and it predicts output per hour worked but not output per unit of capital. **Third**, about twice as much of women's real wage growth as men's came from moving into higher job levels, among both blue- and white-collar workers. Beneath all three, about 86% of real wage growth over 1975–2006 came from higher pay *within* job levels and about 14% from workers moving *up* (25% in 1995–2006). The same split appears in the separate survey that replaced ours in 2007, so the conclusions do not depend on linking the two surveys.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Seminars & Conferences	**2026:** Annual Conference of the Central Bank of Brazil (Banco Central do Brasil); North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society (June); CESifo Area Conference on Macro with Micro Data (June, Poster); ICMAIF (University of Crete, May) **2025:** CASFI Summer Meeting; BCFM; CRC TR 224 Retreat **2024:** Summer Meeting of the SED (Barcelona, Presenter); Banca d'Italia (Rome, Poster); Money Conference (Board of Governors); Center for Advanced Studies in Finance and Inequality (Bonn); Firm Heterogeneity and Macroeconomics (Bonn/Mannheim, 2022–2024) **2023:** HANK Conference (Berlin)
Informal Supervision of Master Theses	**2025:** Marius Trovik (1.0) **2024:** Zsigmond Szajbely (1.0) **2023:** Luke Liscio (1.0) **2021:** Anna Sanchez (1.7)
Schools & Workshops	**Summer Schools:** Macroeconomics and Financial Markets (June 2022, Dean Corbae), DSE 2024 **Spring Schools:** Macroeconomics and Big Data (April 2024, Domenico Giannone, Giorgio Primiceri) **Workshops:** Empirical Methods in Macroeconomics (May 2024, Christian Wolf)
Personal	**Citizenship:** U.S. (German in progress) **Ethnicity:** Latino **Languages:** English, Spanish, German (B1)